

REAL HELP FOR THE FAMILY

SONG #109 – Love Intensely from the heart

INTRO

HAPPY GOD WANTS YOUR FAMILY TO BE HAPPY (3 min.)

All families yearn to be happy, yet some are plagued by hurtful speech, disrespect, disloyalty, and a lack of warmth

Such problems reflect common traits of “the last days” (2Ti 3:1-5)

Jehovah God has provided guidance for families because he wants them to be happy (Isa 48:17, 18)

WHEN BIBLE COUNSEL IS APPLIED, even difficult family problems can be overcome

- Religiously Divided Household
- Children that is slow to respond to training
- Deeply Entrenched Bad Habits
- Trusts Between marriage mates has been damaged.

CHALLENGES TO FAMILY HAPPINESS CAN BE OVERCOME (16 min.)

A HOUSEHOLD MAY BE RELIGIOUSLY DIVIDED, or perhaps not all family members apply Bible counsel

Jehovah will bless those who promote peace despite unfavorable circumstances (Col 3:23, 24)

PEOPLE may close their ears to your advice, but to your examples, they are all eyes

A believing mate can influence the unbelieving spouse positively (DISCUSS **1Pe 3:1, 2**)

AT TIMES, CHILDREN MAY BE SLOW TO RESPOND to parental training or even rebel against their parents

DISCUSS A1

Maintain open communication with children, be a good listener, and reason patiently (*g 10/11 16-20; g 8/07 8*)

Parents, NEVER give up, but **patiently** and **firmly** continue assisting your children (Ga 6:9)

SOME FAMILIES HAVE DEEPLY ENTRENCHED BAD HABITS, such as arguing and using unkind speech

DISCUSS B1

Such habits can be overcome by applying Bible principles **[Read Col 3:12]**

DISCUSS B2

Learn to handle disagreements and problems in a peaceful way (w08 5/1 10-12; g 2/13 4-5)

Be patient, recognizing that forming new habits takes time

Resolve to let go of resentment over past wrongs **[Read Colossians 3:13]**

IF TRUST BETWEEN MARRIAGE MATES has been damaged, it may be possible to restore it

Perhaps one mate has developed an inappropriate emotional bond outside the marriage, or flirting

To begin repairing the damage, the offending mate needs to change his or her behavior and apologize (Col 3:5, 9)

Marriage mates can continue to rebuild trust by cultivating openness and honesty

Adultery is a serious betrayal of trust

An innocent mate must weigh carefully the decision whether to forgive or to divorce (Mt 5:32)

If forgiveness is extended, both mates must work together to strengthen the marriage (w12 5/1 12-15)

SECRET RECIPE - UNSELFISHNESS IS THE KEY TO A HAPPY FAMILY

Selfishness is at the root of many family problems

Satan promotes the idea that self-interest leads to happiness

In reality, greater happiness comes from giving (Ac 20:35)

Unselfish love is a powerful uniting bond **[Read Colossians 3:14]**

Genuine love is not merely an emotion; it is displayed by unselfish actions (1Co 13:4-7)

An unselfish husband puts his family's needs and interests ahead of his own
[Read Colossians 3:19, 21]

In public and in private, he treats his family with dignity, being gentle and kind

An unselfish wife supports her husband and works hard for the welfare of the family **[Read Col 3:18]**

Children who are not self-willed but obedient contribute to a peaceful, happy home **[Read Col 3:20]**

All of us plays a ROLE.

STRENGTHEN YOUR COMMITMENT TO YOUR FAMILY (3 min.)

By **words** and **actions**, show that you are committed to making your family life a success (g 6/15 8-9)

DISCUSS C1

Strong commitment provides a firm foundation for resolving problems.

UNSELFISHNESS LOVE and COMMITMENT – Real Help for the Families.

Jehovah God will bless your efforts as (Pr 16:3) - *Commit to Jehovah whatever you do, And your plans will succeed.*